WEEK 8 · LECTURE L3 · UNIT III

Specific Segments, Differentiation and Fairness

Talent differentiation, idiosyncratic deals, organizational justice, and designing for specific segments of the workforce.

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AFTER THIS LECTURE YOU SHOULD BE ABLE TO

What this lecture prepares you for

- Evaluate the case for and against exclusive talent management.
- Distinguish an idiosyncratic deal from favoritism.
- Apply the four dimensions of organizational justice and the rules of fair procedure.
- Design for a workforce segment by its mechanism, not its label.

COURSE OUTCOMES

CLO 5 (create programs for diverse workforces) and CLO 2 (apply engagement strategies).

COMMIT BEFORE THEORY

A high rated engineer may leave. Is it fair to give her a deal no peer is offered?

Fair, unfair, or it depends. If it depends, on what?

THEORY IN DEPTH · COLLINGS AND MELLAHI (2009)

The case for differentiation

THE CORE IDEA

Some positions contribute disproportionately to strategy, so invest disproportionately in the people who fill them.

HOW IT WORKS

Identify pivotal positions, build a pool of high potential talent, and differentiate HR practice to fit.

LIMITS AND CRITIQUE

Differentiation signals to the excluded majority that they matter less, with justice and morale costs.

IN PRACTICE

A pharmaceutical firm treats regulatory affairs roles as pivotal and builds succession pools for them.

EXAM LENS

Note the starting point: pivotal positions, not the people rated highest. That distinction earns marks.

Idiosyncratic deals

THE CORE IDEA

I deals are voluntary, personalized terms negotiated between an individual and the employer, benefiting both.

HOW IT WORKS

They cover flexibility, development or tasks, and are agreed at hiring or later.

LIMITS AND CRITIQUE

Coworkers accept them only when the process is transparent and the same chance is open to them.

IN PRACTICE

A senior analyst negotiates a four day week while keeping her targets, through an open process.

EXAM LENS

Distinguish i deals from favoritism: open, tied to contribution and mutually beneficial.

THE FAIRNESS TEST · COLQUITT (2001)

Four dimensions of organizational justice

Dimension	Fairness of
Distributive	The outcomes people receive
Procedural	The processes that decide outcomes
Interpersonal	The dignity and respect people are shown
Informational	The explanations people are given

EXAM LENS

Leventhal (1980): fair procedures are consistent, free of bias, accurate, correctable, representative and ethical.

HOW JUSTICE WORKS

Justice judgments form early and last

LIND (2001)

Justice judgments form early and then act as a shortcut for deciding whether to trust.

SINGH AND SINGH (2019)

In an Indian sample, justice related to empowerment, which with citizenship behavior related to job satisfaction.

THEORY FOR EACH SEGMENT

Design for the mechanism, not the label

Segment	Theory	Mechanism to address
Women returners	Kaleidoscope careers	Shifting weight of authenticity, balance and challenge
Contract and gig workers	Nonstandard employment	Outside the usual employment and justice system
Smaller city employees	Job embeddedness	Strong local ties raise the cost of relocation
High potentials	Exclusive talent management	Pivotal role; justice for those excluded

Mainiero and Sullivan (2005); Kalleberg (2000); Mitchell et al. (2001); Collings and Mellahi (2009)

COMPARE AND EVALUATE

Inclusive versus exclusive talent management

	Inclusive	Exclusive
Assumption	Everyone has talent to develop	Some roles matter more
Strength	Fairness and broad engagement	Focused investment
Risk	Spread too thin	Justice costs for the majority
Safeguard	Clear priorities	Transparent, correctable criteria

PRACTICE FOR THE END TERM EXAMINATION

Questions to rehearse

"Talent differentiation is unfair to most employees." Critically evaluate using justice theory. **20 marks**

A strong answer: explains exclusive talent management and i deals; applies Colquitt and Leventhal; proposes safeguards; reaches a view.

Design a retention approach for women returning to work in an Indian firm. **20 marks**

A strong answer: uses kaleidoscope careers; designs by mechanism; tests the design against justice rules; notes risks.

Distinguish procedural from distributive justice. **10 marks**

A strong answer: definitions; one example each; why procedures matter when outcomes disappoint.

CARRY THESE INTO THE EXAMINATION

Three things to remember

1. Differentiate by pivotal role, not by rating alone
2. An i deal is open and mutual; favoritism is neither
3. Fair procedures protect trust when outcomes disappoint

SET READINGS · FROM THE LESSON PLAN

Read for this lecture

Costanza, D. P., Badger, J. M., Fraser, R. L., Severt, J. B., & Gade, P. A. (2012). Generational differences in work related attitudes: A meta analysis. *Journal of Business and Psychology, 27*(4), 375–394.

McKinsey & Company. (2022, July). The Great Attrition is making hiring harder. Are you searching the right talent pools? *McKinsey Quarterly*.

People Matters: selected articles on the employee lifecycle, as listed in the Lesson Plan.

Singh, S. K., & Singh, A. P. (2019). Interplay of organizational justice, psychological empowerment, organizational citizenship behavior, and job satisfaction in the context of circular economy. *Management Decision, 57*(4), 937–952.

HOW TO USE THESE

These are the Week 8 set readings. Singh and Singh (2019) is the core reading for this lecture. Note: the Lesson Plan lists Singh and Singh (2019) under the Journal of Indian Business Research; the verified published record is shown here.

THEORY SOURCES · FOR REFERENCE

Sources for this lecture (1 of 3)

Works named on the slides of this lecture. They are background sources, not set readings.

Collings, D. G., & Mellahi, K. (2009). Strategic talent management: A review and research agenda. *Human Resource Management Review, 19*(4), 304–313. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.hrmr.2009.04.001

Colquitt, J. A. (2001). On the dimensionality of organizational justice: A construct validation of a measure. *Journal of Applied Psychology, 86*(3), 386–400. https://doi.org/10.1037/0021-9010.86.3.386

Kalleberg, A. L. (2000). Nonstandard employment relations: Part time, temporary and contract work. *Annual Review of Sociology, 26*(1), 341–365. https://doi.org/10.1146/annurev.soc.26.1.341

Sources for this lecture (2 of 3)

Leventhal, G. S. (1980). What should be done with equity theory? In K. J. Gergen, M. S. Greenberg, & R. H. Willis (Eds.), *Social exchange: Advances in theory and research* (pp. 27–55). Plenum.

Lind, E. A. (2001). Fairness heuristic theory: Justice judgments as pivotal cognitions in organizational relations. In J. Greenberg & R. Cropanzano (Eds.), *Advances in organizational justice* (pp. 56–88). Stanford University Press.

Mainiero, L. A., & Sullivan, S. E. (2005). Kaleidoscope careers: An alternate explanation for the "opt out" revolution. *Academy of Management Executive, 19*(1), 106–123. https://doi.org/10.5465/ame.2005.15841962

Sources for this lecture (3 of 3)

Mitchell, T. R., Holtom, B. C., Lee, T. W., Sablynski, C. J., & Erez, M. (2001). Why people stay: Using job embeddedness to predict voluntary turnover. *Academy of Management Journal, 44*(6), 1102–1121. https://doi.org/10.2307/3069391

Rousseau, D. M., Ho, V. T., & Greenberg, J. (2006). I deals: Idiosyncratic terms in employment relationships. *Academy of Management Review, 31*(4), 977–994. https://doi.org/10.5465/amr.2006.22527470

Singh, S. K., & Singh, A. P. (2019). Interplay of organizational justice, psychological empowerment, organizational citizenship behavior, and job satisfaction in the context of circular economy. *Management Decision, 57*(4), 937–952. https://doi.org/10.1108/md-09-2018-0966